

Police Merit Commission Meeting September 18th 2025

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8WmBsUzXsr8
Publication Date	2025-09-18T22:12:17Z
Target Category	muncie_city

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Municipal Meeting Summary Report

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

Omitted (None present in the transcript).

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The presiding officer called the Muny Police Merit Commission meeting to order on Thursday, September 18th, 2025, at 6:05 p.m. [00:00:24](#)
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Paul, Chuck Simmers, Chris Aguular, Steve Craig, Mark Urban, and Nathan Slo. (Note: DFL is also recorded during roll call).
 - **Members Absent:** None explicitly noted.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Identified as the President of the Commission.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** None recorded in the transcript.
- **Approval of Minutes:**
 - [00:00:48](#) The minutes of the September 4th, 2025 meeting were presented, motioned, seconded, and approved by voice vote.

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:01:38 Item 6: Police Chief Business <U+2013> Appointment of Special Officers**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Police Chief.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The Chief requested the appointment of two individuals as special officers for the Muny Police Department (MPD):
 1. **Jim Johnson:** A former MPD officer and detective of over two decades who recently retired from the Gaming Commission.
 2. **Gavin Green:** A longtime department reserve.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:02:50 Item 6 (Continued): Police Chief Business <U+2013> Promotion to Sergeant**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Police Chief (requesting names from the prospective Sergeant List provided by the Commission President).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** To fill an open sergeant position, the Chief requested the top three names from the prospective list (Mariah Copelan, Maverick Ratzikis, and Daniel Bradford) and formally asked for the promotion of Mariah Copelan. The Chief shared a brief professional biography highlighting her hire date (November 26, 2018), night shift patrol work, Field Training Officer (FTO) status, assignment to the Criminal Investigations Division (CID) on January 8, 2022, negotiation team membership, instruction credentials (CPR and "Stop the Bleed"), flock administration duties, and evidence technician role.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote. (Followed by a ceremonial badge pinning with her partner, MPD Officer Aaron Gross).

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

Omitted (No open public comment period or citizen speakers were recorded in the transcript).

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:** Attorney Mark Irvvin reported no business for the commission.
- **Adjournment:** A motion to adjourn was made, seconded, and passed by voice vote. The meeting officially adjourned at 6:10 p.m. **00:05:40**